



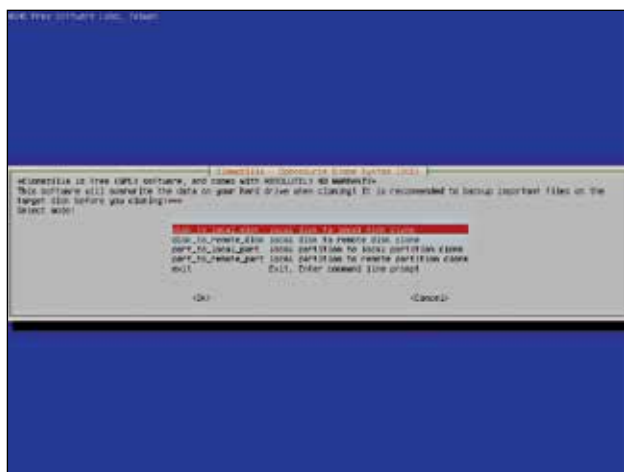
Lego curiosity rover

Lego fans rejoice! Now you can buy an official Lego model of NASA's Mars Curiosity Rover. <http://dgit.in/CurioLego>

Have you played 'em?

Check out this link for some of the most overlooked games of 2013 and check them off your list. <http://dgit.in/Ov3r1ukd>

Workshop



Clonezilla UI: Not the best in the world, but simply works

an external source which is in no way connected to a network – neither yours or anyone else's. After the image is created, remember to take an image of the 100MB Windows recovery partition on your hard drive and save it on the same aforementioned source.

This stock image of your PC is what we like to call your 'Clean Clone' (CC). In case your PC gets infected or corrupt, or just gets plain slow due to excessive and/or careless use, the CC can be used to bring back your PC to the exact state it was in when you created the CC.

When you have an oops moment somewhere down the line (a crack which wasn't a crack at all?) and your PC needs to be cleared, all you need is GParted, a free partition editor for graphically managing your disk partitions and your CC.

Run GParted on your PC to format an infected partition to remove all traces of viruses and then restore the image you've saved in your CC through Clonezilla to return to your clean system.

In case you forget to back up the Windows recovery partition, you may have a bootmgr issue, which can be resolved with a Windows boot disc. Learn how to create one from our Thinkdigit article on installing Windows <http://dgit.in/instWin>

However similar Clonezilla may seem to using a system restore point, there are certain pros and cons of both these techniques. The restore point may change your install and registry files to an earlier, more stable state, but it doesn't affect the files on your PC. The problem

with this is that if you're infected with malware or any other virus, there's a high chance it will still be there after the restore. Clonezilla solves this issue, but also wipes off any data you may have downloaded onto the PC after you created the CC, so be wary of that.

Clean install (the hard but right way)

As an ultimate step, you could begin right from the start. This basically involves removing everything from your PC and reinstalling your OS and software from scratch. Yes, it's quite the task, but sometimes issues like a boot sector virus and particularly intelligent malware can force one to take such inevitable steps.

The process is pretty standard, but if you need to know more about it, check out our article on disinfecting your PC at <http://dgit.in/disinPC>

Things to do before wiping your PC clean

Here's a short generic checklist of things to keep in mind before you completely erase your PC.

- **Flickr has 1TB space for your photos:** Don't keep your precious memories at risk of being wiped out. Though not enough for every photo a professional photographer takes, 1TB is enough to keep the important ones backed up in case of emergencies. And if you're a smartphone pic taker, go Flickr!
- **Autofill form data and saved passwords:** Not really priority #1, but it's a luxury which, if you use often, is a pain to have to live without. And thus, it makes it into our pre-cleanup

bucket list. If you use Chrome, then simply sync it all with your Google account. If you use Firefox, check out <http://dgit.in/FoxFill> at the Firefox forum for help.

- **Ninite:** A website for downloading bulk essential software for clean boot is <http://ninite.com/> From anti-viruses and web browsers to music players and messaging apps, Ninite keeps it all ready to be downloaded in one bundle. Simply tick your necessary boxes, and click on 'Get installer'. If you don't want to dig into your precious bandwidth, simply pop in any of our Digit DVDs and look for the Essentials section. If you didn't notice already, we've had your back for years, now.
- **Sticky Notes:** They're in your face all the time, but it's very easy to forget to back up these important virtual post-



Cloud storage: The future home base of data

its on your desktop. Avoid the hassle of recalling what your sticky notes remembered for you, and simply remember to take them with you. Press [Win] + [R], type in '%App-Data%\Microsoft\Sticky Notes\' and press [Enter]. This would lead you to a .snt file. Copy this SNT file to your backup folder.

- **Google Drive/Sky Drive:** Your documents and other smaller files are important too. Back up your files on Google Drive, Sky Drive, or any of the other cloud storage tools out there. Cloud computing is the future. Hop on the bandwagon!

Be careful

Don't put yourself in a situation where you have to do a clean install in the first place! Take care of your PC and your PC will take care of you.



1TB photo storage on Flickr